

Beyond Vaibhav Sooryavanshi: How India A's Dambulla Tri-Nation title revealed country's rich talent pool

India A's **title-winning run** in Dambulla highlighted emerging stars, resilience under pressure and the depth of India's cricket talent beyond the headlines.

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The trophy will eventually find a place inside the BCCI headquarters. The scorecards will slip quietly into databases. Years from now, highlight reels will still replay Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's astonishing 29-ball 94.

But India-A's triumph in the Tri-Nation series in Dambulla will be remembered for far more than the silverware.

For a fortnight at the Rangiri International Stadium, amid sticky afternoons, sudden showers and pitches that kept changing their character, a young Indian side learnt lessons no coaching manual can teach.

It was about handling setbacks, reading unfamiliar conditions, recovering from disappointment and discovering, once again, just how deep India's talent pool really is.

India-A lifted the title after winning three of its five league games and crushing Sri Lanka-A by 66 runs in the

final. More than 1,500 runs were scored along the way, but the campaign was defined by much more than sheer volume.

There were careers to rebuild, reputations to strengthen and dreams beginning to take shape. Ruturaj Gaikwad perhaps had the most to gain. Returning after a lengthy break, he arrived needing runs more than headlines. They came in the opening game itself. Walking in with India-A wobbling, he joined Tilak Varma in a 150-run partnership before bringing up his

Bright future: India-A sealed the title with a 66-run win over Sri Lanka-A in the final after winning three of its five league matches. It amassed more than 1,500 runs across the tournament, but the numbers tell only part of the story. SLC

